DAY 31 · THEORY HANDOUT

Split Long Text Into Useful Chunks

Choose chunk size, overlap, and metadata before building search.

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The idea and its useful terms

Choose chunk size, overlap, and metadata before building search.

Chunk

One smaller piece of a longer document.

Chunk size

The maximum length used by a splitter.

Overlap

Text repeated at the edge of neighboring chunks.

A whole book is too much context for one small question. Chunks let search return only useful parts.

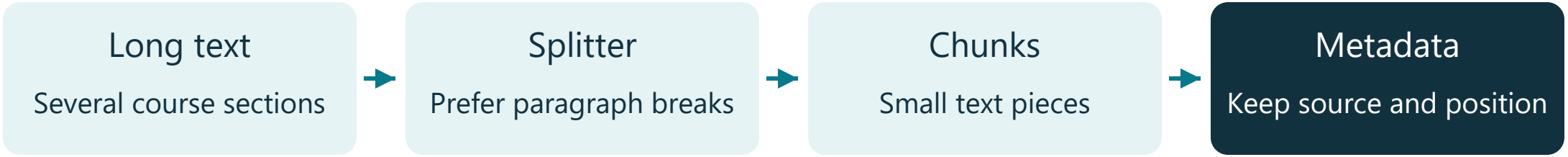
A little overlap can keep a sentence's context across a cut. Too much overlap repeats text and increases storage and input size.

> Chunk quality depends on the document and question. Test useful questions before choosing a size.

Follow the work, one step at a time

Each step has a job. We can inspect its output before moving on.

Read the path from left to right.



Each arrow means: pass the result to the next step.

A recursive splitter first tries larger breaks, such as paragraphs, then smaller breaks when needed. chunk_size is the target maximum for its chosen length measure. chunk_overlap is the amount it tries to repeat.

An overlap setting does not always create an exact repeated length when natural breaks are kept. Print actual chunks. Keep source metadata with each one so a retrieved piece can still be traced to the file.

> If the answer is wrong, inspect the input and the intermediate results. The last sentence alone cannot show which step failed.

A small example we can check

The values here are classroom examples. The notebook shows actual results.

Chunk A

Python uses names...

Lists store many values.

Overlap

Lists store many values.

Repeated at the edge.

Chunk B

Lists store many values.

Pandas uses tables...

Read the given input first. Point to the fact or value needed for the requested output.

Run the matching example, then try the fresh input at the end of the notebook. Compare both results with the known input.

> Chunk quality depends on the document and question. Test useful questions before choosing a size.

Choose the setting or tool for its job

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A different choice changes the work. These are the choices we compare.

Too small

May split a useful idea.

Search lacks context.

Too large

Contains unrelated ideas.

More text enters prompts.

Measure first

Characters are not tokens.

Know the splitter's unit.

Split a short course note with character size 180 and overlap 30.

Print each chunk and its length. These values are demo choices, not universal defaults.

> Change one value at a time. Check whether a full answer sentence stays together.

Practice, check, and read the full lesson

Use the notebook to try the steps. Use the article when you need the longer explanation.

1. Build

Run the small example.

Inspect each step.

2. Change

Try the fresh input.

Keep the goal clear.

3. Check

Compare with the source.

Keep mistakes visible.

Change one value at a time. Check whether a full answer sentence stays together.

Read the complete tutorial breakdown for this section in our KGP Talkie article.

> Chunk quality depends on the document and question. Test useful questions before choosing a size.

DAY 31 · COMPLETE

Thank You

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